



Ready to download but don't know from where? Use these popular download sites as a reference when you feel the urge to download...



Download.com is one of the most popular download sites on the Internet

Software: Download.com (www.download.com) and Tucows (www.tucows.com) are probably the most popular download sites on the Web. They have a huge col-

lection of files and several mirror locations. Tucows has six mirrors in India! **Linux:** If you need to download a distribution of Linux, check out LinuxISO (www.linuxiso.org). It contains links to popular variants of Linux that are available. Also, you may want to check out Source Forge (www.sourceforge.net) and FreshMeat (www.freshmeat.net) to download interesting Linux projects.

Music Downloads: No—this is not a link to illegal downloads. Rather, Epitonic (www.epitonic.com) hosts songs which are free for download. If you are still interested, you may find the site worth your time.



Working with archives is easy with WinZIP

load managers support download categories—each category will have a separate directory. While downloading, select the relevant category and you are done. If you would rather download files to a central location, try to use file organizers such as SoftPrime's Advanced File Organizer. It is a comprehensive database, and provides a centralised view to all related files. It allows you to create reports and sort files to your hearts content.

Finally, do keep updating your download manager periodically so that they can give you their best. Also, as far as possible, do try to download during off-peak hours. This way, you ensure effective use of your bandwidth and get the most out of your Internet connection. ■

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WinAce 2.20 (www.winace.com) is a powerful program that supports compression and decompression in multiple formats. The program uses its own ACE format, which packs data at a good compression level. In addition to this, it can compress in popular archive formats such as ZIP and MS-CAB, and can recognize and extract popular archive formats such as RAR and ARJ.

The interface is simple and the extraction process is quite fast. The program allows you to build self-extracting volumes for the ACE and ZIP formats. Also, it allows you to span a file across multiple volumes—this is useful as it allows you to carry a large archive in smaller segments.

WinRAR 3.20 (www.rarlab.com) is a popular compression software that allows you to read a variety of formats. It has a slew of great features that are not commonly found in other archiving software. One of the best ones is that most of it can be operated without opening a window. The interface is minimalist, and the extraction and compression process can be done in the background. It can also read ISO images.

Arguably the most popular compression software, WinZIP 8.1 (www.winzip.com) features a simple interface and provides for an easy way to extract your archives. It is tightly integrated with the Explorer and allows you to create self-extracting archives.

PowerArchiver 2003 (www.powerarchiver.com) is another variant that is packed with all the features you'd need in a compression software. It has support for a large number of compression formats. It also has a password management system to access frequently used archives. The internal file viewer allows you to preview a variety of file formats. The program is fully skinnable, supports the popular Windows Blinds software for skinning, and also has tools to repair corrupted ZIP files.

If you download files regularly, indexing and cataloging downloaded files becomes important. Most down-

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